

Zongxia Li

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College Park, MD

Ph.D. candidate in computer science researching self-evolving agents, multimodal post-training, and human-AI collaboration.

EDUCATION

University of Maryland, College Park

Expected June 2027

Ph.D. in Computer Science

College Park, MD

University of Maryland, College Park

May 2022

B.S. in Computer Science and B.S. in Mathematics

College Park, MD

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

CLIP Lab, University of Maryland

Sep 2022 – Present

Graduate Research Assistant, advised by Jordan Boyd-Graber and Lichao Sun

College Park, MD

- Research self-evolving agents, multimodal post-training, and human-AI collaboration, long-horizon tasks.
- First-author or co-first-author on projects including Long-Horizon-Terminal-Bench, MM-Zero, Self-Rewarding VLM, VideoHallu, and ComfyClaw.
- Published work spanning ICLR, CVPR, NeurIPS, ACL, and EMNLP.

LLM Frontier Lab

May 2026 – Aug 2026

Research Scientist Intern, mentored by Yucheng Shi

Bellevue, WA

- Work on building and synthesizing agentic long-horizon tasks such as terminal tasks, coding tasks.
- Work on self-improving agents from generating data from its own on long-horizon tasks.

Tencent AI Lab

May 2025 – Aug 2025

Research Scientist Intern, mentored by Wenhao Yu

Bellevue, WA

- Worked on self-evolving large language models and vision-language models using reinforcement learning and self-rewarding objectives.
- Studied methods for grounding multimodal models in visual understanding and reasoning.

Adobe, Document Intelligence Lab

May 2024 – Aug 2024

Research Assistant Intern, mentored by Ani Nenkova

College Park, MD

- Studied judge-ensemble methods for long-form text generation evaluation to improve agreement with expert human judgments.
- Compared LLM-based evaluators with crowdsourced annotations for reliable automatic evaluation.

National Institute of Technology

May 2023 – May 2024

Graduate Research Assistant, mentored by Juan Fung

College Park, MD

- Developed machine learning methods for content analysis and interactive data exploration.
- Ran ablation studies to understand how users learn from and navigate large document collections.

PUBLICATIONS

* equal contribution.

2026

1. **Zongxia Li***, Zhongzhi Li*, Yucheng Shi*, Ruhan Wang, Junyao Yang, Zhichao Liu, Xiyang Wu, Anhao Li, Yue Yu, Ninghao Liu, Lichao Sun, and Haotao Mi. **Long-Horizon-Terminal-Bench: Testing the Limits of Agents on Long-Horizon Terminal Tasks with Dense Reward-Based Grading**. Preprint, 2026.
2. Ruhan Wang, Yucheng Shi, **Zongxia Li**, Zhongzhi Li, Yue Yu, Junyao Yang, Kishan Panaganti, Haitao Mi, and Dongruo Zhou. **Harness Handbook: Making Evolving Agent Harnesses Readable, Navigable, and Editable**. Preprint, 2026.
3. **Zongxia Li***, Hongyang Du*, Chengsong Huang*, Xiyang Wu, Lantao Yu, Yicheng He, Jing Xie, Xiaomin Wu, Zhichao Liu, Jiarui Zhang, and Fuxiao Liu. **MM-Zero: Self-Evolving Multi-Model Vision Language Models from Zero Data**. EMNLP, 2026.
4. **Zongxia Li***, Dawei Liu*, Fuxiao Liu, Yuhang Zhou, Xiyang Wu, Jingxi Chen, Jing Xie, Xiaomin Wu, and Lichao Sun. **ComfyClaw: Self-Evolving Skill Harnesses for Image Generation Workflows**. Preprint, 2026.

5. Dawei Liu*, **Zongxia Li***, Hongyang Du, Xiyang Wu, Shihang Gui, Yongbei Kuang, and Lichao Sun. **Graph of Skills: Dependency-Aware Structural Retrieval for Massive Agent Skills**. ACM Conference on AI and Agentic Systems (Agent Skills), 2026.
6. Xiyang Wu, **Zongxia Li**, Guangyao Shi, Alexander Duffy, Tyler Marques, Matthew Lyle Olson, Tianyi Zhou, and Dinesh Manocha. **Co-Evolving LLM Decision and Skill Bank Agents for Long-Horizon Tasks**. ACM Conference on AI and Agentic Systems (Agent Skills), 2026.
7. Chengsong Huang, Haolin Liu, Tong Zheng, Runpeng Dai, Langlin Huang, Jinyuan Li, **Zongxia Li**, Zhepei Wei, Yu Meng, and Jiaxin Huang. **G-Zero: Self-Play for Open-Ended Generation from Zero Data**. Preprint, 2026.
8. Feng Gu, **Zongxia Li**, Carlos Rafael Colon, Benjamin Evans, Ishani Mondal, and Jordan Lee Boyd-Graber. **Large Language Models Are Effective Human Annotation Assistants, but Not Good Independent Annotators**. ACL, 2026.
9. Zhishang Xiang, Chengyi Yang, Zerui Chen, Zhimin Wei, Yunbo Tang, Zongpei Teng, Zexi Peng, **Zongxia Li**, Chengsong Huang, Yicheng He, Chang Yang, Xinrun Wang, Xiao Huang, Qinggang Zhang, and Jinsong Su. **A Systematic Survey of Self-Evolving Agents: From Model-Centric to Environment-Driven Co-Evolution**. TechRxiv, 2026.

2025

10. **Zongxia Li***, Wenhao Yu*, Chengsong Huang, Rui Liu, Zhenwen Liang, Fuxiao Liu, Jingxi Che, Dian Yu, Jordan Boyd-Graber, Haitao Mi, and Dong Yu. **Self-Rewarding Vision-Language Model via Reasoning Decomposition**. ICLR, 2026.
11. **Zongxia Li***, Xiyang Wu*, Guangyao Shi, Yubin Qin, Hongyang Du, Tianyi Zhou, Dinesh Manocha, and Jordan Lee Boyd-Graber. **VideoHallu: Evaluating and Mitigating Multi-Modal Hallucinations on Synthetic Video Understanding**. NeurIPS, 2025.
12. Jingxi Chen*, **Zongxia Li***, Zhichao Liu, Guangyao Shi, Xiyang Wu, Fuxiao Liu, Cornelia Fermuller, Brandon Y. Feng, and Yiannis Aloimonos. **First Frame Is the Place to Go for Video Content Customization**. CVPR, 2026.
13. Yicheng He*, Chengsong Huang*, **Zongxia Li***, Jiaxin Huang, and Yonghui Yang. **VisPlay: Self-Evolving Vision-Language Models from Images**. CVPR, 2026.
14. Xiyang Wu, **Zongxia Li**, Jihui Jin, Guangyao Shi, Gouthaman K. V., Vishnu Raj, Nilotpal Sinha, Jingxi Chen, Fan Du, and Dinesh Manocha. **MASS: Motion-Aware Spatial-Temporal Grounding for Physics Reasoning and Comprehension in Vision-Language Models**. CVPR Findings, 2026.
15. Chengsong Huang, Wenhao Yu, Xiaoyang Wang, Hongming Zhang, **Zongxia Li**, Ruosen Li, Jiaxin Huang, Haitao Mi, and Dong Yu. **R-Zero: Self-Evolving Reasoning LLM from Zero Data**. ICLR, 2026.
16. **Zongxia Li**, Lorena Calvo-Bartolomé, Alexander Hoyle, Paiheng Xu, Daniel Stephens, Alden Dima, Juan Francisco Fung, and Jordan Boyd-Graber. **Large Language Models Struggle to Describe the Haystack without Human Help: A Social Science-Inspired Evaluation of Topic Models**. ACL, 2025.
17. **Zongxia Li**, Xiyang Wu, Hongyang Du, Fuxiao Liu, Huy Nghiem, and Guangyao Shi. **State of the Art Large Vision Language Models: Benchmark Evaluations and Challenges**. CVPR Workshops, 2025.

2024

18. **Zongxia Li**, Ishani Mondal, Yijun Liang, Huy Nghiem, and Jordan Lee Boyd-Graber. **PEDANTS: Cheap but Effective and Interpretable Answer Equivalence**. EMNLP, 2024.
19. Ishani Mondal, **Zongxia Li**, Yufang Hou, Anandhavelu Natarajan, Aparna Garimella, and Jordan Boyd-Graber. **SciDoc2Diagrammer-MAF: Towards Generation of Scientific Diagrams from Documents Guided by Multi-Aspect Feedback Refinement**. EMNLP, 2024.
20. **Zongxia Li**, Andrew Mao, Daniel Stephens, Pranav Goel, Emily Walpole, Alden Dima, Juan Fung, and Jordan Boyd-Graber. **Improving the TENOR of Labeling: Re-Evaluating Topic Models for Content Analysis**. EACL, 2024.
21. Fuxiao Liu, Tianrui Guan, **Zongxia Li**, Lichang Chen, Yaser Yacoob, Dinesh Manocha, and Tianyi Zhou. **HALLUSIONBENCH: You See What You Think? Or You Think What You See?.** CVPR, 2024.
22. Haozhe An, Christabel Acquaye, Colin Wang, **Zongxia Li**, and Rachel Rudinger. **Do Large Language Models Discriminate in Hiring Decisions on the Basis of Race, Ethnicity, and Gender?.** ACL, 2024.

2023

23. Haozhe An, **Zongxia Li**, Jieyu Zhao, and Rachel Rudinger. **SODAPOP: Open-Ended Discovery of Social Biases in Social Commonsense Reasoning Models**. EACL, 2023.

SELECTED OPEN-SOURCE PROJECTS

- **Large Vision-Language Models: A Survey & Benchmark Collection** – Curated repository of VLM benchmarks, RL alignment methods, and applications.
- **Dr. Claw: Your AI Research Assistant** – AI research assistant platform for agentic research workflows.

SKILLS

Research: Vision-language models, multimodal reasoning, reinforcement learning, post-training, agent systems, human-AI collaboration, evaluation

Languages: Python, C, R, Java, JavaScript

Frameworks/Tools: PyTorch, SQLite, Git, HTML/CSS, L^AT_EX

AWARDS

- **Lambda Labs Research Compute Grant**, 2025
- **NIST Fellowship Award**